CHURN IS DEAD

# The Product Triage Bridge Audit

A 1-Page Operational Blueprint & Scoring Framework for CS-Product Sprint Alignment

This diagnostic tool helps Customer Success and Product Ops teams benchmark their ability to convert frontline customer friction into active engineering sprint tickets within 48 hours based on verified revenue risk.

**Scoring:** Rate each item 1-5. 1 = Not happening / pure informal lobbying, 5 = Fully embedded in operations with hard financial gates.

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**Source:** churnisdead.com
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SECTION 1

## Blocked Revenue Thresholding

Without explicit financial caps, every support ticket demands equal priority, turning engineering escalations into arbitrary shouting matches.

| Criteria | What Good Looks Like | What Bad Looks Like |
|---|---|---|
| Minimum ARR Qualification | A strict, non-negotiable financial baseline (e.g., $100k+ ARR or aggregate multi-account ARR risk) is required before an issue enters product triage. | Any CSM can escalate any ticket regardless of account contract value, clogging engineering queues with low-impact noise. |
| Quantified Operational Friction | Tickets require mandatory intake fields calculating weekly user hours lost alongside total ARR at risk before submission. | Friction is communicated using subjective tags like 'critical issue', 'unhappy customer', or 'high urgency'. |
| Objective Impact Formula | Escalations are ranked using an explicit formula: Friction Score = (ARR at Risk) x (Weekly Manual Labor Hours Lost). | Escalations are prioritized by whichever CSM screams loudest in Slack or whichever sales deal is closing this week. |

## Score This Section

| Criteria | Score |
|---|---|
| 1 - Unscored / Ad-hoc | Escalations are based on CSM gut feelings or executive Slack messages with zero financial validation. |
| 3 - Defined / Informal | ARR thresholds exist as general guidelines but are frequently bypassed or ignored during prioritization. |
| 5 - Operationalized | Strict ARR and labor-loss formulas act as hard, mandatory gates for triage queue eligibility. |

**Your Score: ____ / 5**

SECTION 2

## Bi-Weekly Sprint Trading

> Customer Success cannot protect Net Retention Rate without dedicated engineering capacity directly traded against verified revenue risk.

| Criteria | What Good Looks Like | What Bad Looks Like |
|---|---|---|
| Dedicated Capacity Allocation | Product and Engineering pre-allocate a fixed quota (e.g., 10-15%) of every sprint cycle specifically for revenue remediation. | CS begs for engineering favors or relies on developers working on bugs during unallocated 'slack time'. |
| Structured Trading Cadence | A recurring 30-minute bi-weekly session occurs between CS Leadership and Product Ops to trade capacity directly against revenue risk. | Irregular syncs called only when major enterprise accounts issue active termination notices. |
| Resource Trading Mechanics | CS brings verified at-risk ARR data; Product trades pre-allocated engineering points based on quantified financial ROI. | Sessions devolve into political debates over long-term roadmap vision versus customer hand-holding. |

## Score This Section

| Criteria | Score |
|---|---|
| 1 - Unscored / Ad-hoc | CS has no formal seat at sprint planning and relies entirely on informal lobbying. |
| 3 - Defined / Informal | Bi-weekly meetings exist, but engineering capacity allocation is fluctuating, informal, and non-binding. |
| 5 - Operationalized | Hard engineering capacity quotas are locked every sprint and traded strictly on validated ARR risk. |

**Your Score: ____ / 5**

SECTION 3

## Dollar-Weighted Jira Priority

Traditional engineering backlogs prioritize technical debt and feature roadmaps while hiding millions in churn exposure under static bug tags.

| Criteria | What Good Looks Like | What Bad Looks Like |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Financial Metadata Fields | Jira remediation tickets contain required custom fields for 'ARR at Risk', 'Renewal Date', and 'Impacted Accounts'. | Jira items rely on generic P1/P2/P3 priority flags set arbitrarily by support reps. |
| Dynamic Queue Ranking | The product backlog automatically re-orders remediation tickets based on aggregate dollar exposure rather than creation date. | Engineers pick bug tickets based on personal preference, issue simplicity, or FIFO (first-in, first-out) queues. |
| Bi-Directional Sync | Intake tools (CRM/Gainsight) populate Jira metadata automatically within 48 hours without manual data re-entry. | CSMs copy-paste customer complaints into Jira comment threads with zero structured metadata. |

## Score This Section

| Criteria | Score |
| --- | --- |
| 1 - Unscored / Ad-hoc | Jira backlogs contain no financial metadata; remediation items sit buried in thousands of generic bugs. |
| 3 - Defined / Informal | ARR risk is noted in comments or custom fields but does not automatically determine backlog order. |
| 5 - Operationalized | Engineering backlog dynamically ranks triage tickets strictly by real-time dollar-weighted exposure. |

**Your Score: ____ / 5**

SECTION 4

## Fourteen-Day Relief Cadence

Customer trust deteriorates when defect updates are vague; binding resolution timelines turn churn risks into retention wins.

| Criteria | What Good Looks Like | What Bad Looks Like |
|---|---|---|
| 48-Hour Decision SLA | Accepted triage items receive a binding, committed sprint slot or formal rejection within 48 hours of intake. | Defects sit unassigned in an engineering review column for weeks without a clear decision. |
| 14-Day Delivery Commitment | Targeted friction patches deploy to production within 14 calendar days of sprint commitment. | Fixes languish for 100+ days while CSMs deliver repeated political updates to frustrated clients. |
| Closed-Loop Resolution | CSMs present verified production deployment dates and documented time saved directly to executive sponsors. | Fixes are deployed quietly without notifying the customer or measuring operational relief. |

## Score This Section

| Criteria | Score |
|---|---|
| 1 - Unscored / Ad-hoc | Fixes take months with zero SLAs, forcing CSMs to offer empty promises during bi-weekly calls. |
| 3 - Defined / Informal | Target delivery dates are set internally but frequently slip without structured client communication. |
| 5 - Operationalized | Strict 48-hour triage response and 14-day production release cadence backed by automated client updates. |

**Your Score: ____ / 5**

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# Your Scorecard

| Dimension | Your Score | Max |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Blocked Revenue Thresholding | ____ | 5 |
| 2. Bi-Weekly Sprint Trading | ____ | 5 |
| 3. Dollar-Weighted Jira Priority | ____ | 5 |
| 4. Fourteen-Day Relief Cadence | ____ | 5 |
| TOTAL | ____ | 20 |

| Total Score | Assessment | What It Means |
|---|---|---|
| 16-20 | Uncuttable | Embedded, measurable, strategically irreplaceable. |
| 12-15 | Defensible | Solid but gaps remain. Focus on lowest dimension. |
| 8-11 | Vulnerable | Real risk ahead. Treat as urgent. |
| 4-7 | Critical | Cannot survive scrutiny. Major changes needed. |

**What to do next:** Take your lowest-scoring section and build a 30-day action plan. One at a time. Then share this with leadership -- not to ask permission, but to show you know where the gaps are.

*You cannot relationship-manage your way out of a broken API payload. The highest-performing organizations build structural systems that convert customer friction into engineering work orders automatically.*

**-- Kuber**

churnisdead.com | Weekly frameworks that replace hope with strategy.